

tenor

The highest natural adult male voice; also a term describing an instrument in this range.

timbre

The particular quality (literally “stamp”), or character, of a sound that enables a listener to distinguish one instrument (or voice) from another; synonymous with “tone color.”

tonal, tonality

A system of major and minor **scales** and **keys**; forms the basis of all Western music from the 17th century until Schoenberg in the early 20th century.

tone poem

See symphonic poem.

treble

The highest unchanged male voice, or the highest instrument or part in a piece of music.

triad

See chord.

verismo

A post-**Romantic** style of **opera** with thematic material and presentation rooted firmly in reality.